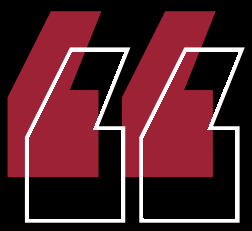


PROFESSIONAL EDUCATION
Digital Plus+ Programs

Persuasive Communication:

Critical Thinking to Enhance Your Mesasge



Communication is only meaningful within the mind of an audience member.
We need to think about how they are decoding our message.

Prof. Edward Schiappa

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Persuasive Communication Today



News, ideas, advertisements, messages, photos, updates, and notifications; our daily lives are filled with a barrage of information.

And this data bombardment can make us less prone to listening attentively, hindering our ability to focus and distinguish what's essential from what isn't.

Accordingly, the demand for professionals to communicate clearly and effectively is more urgent than ever. More than simply transmitting your ideas—a challenge in itself—**professionals and innovators must now learn to capture and maintain their audiences' attention**. While simultaneously establishing credibility, effective communication also ensures that listeners understand the speaker's message without losing focus.

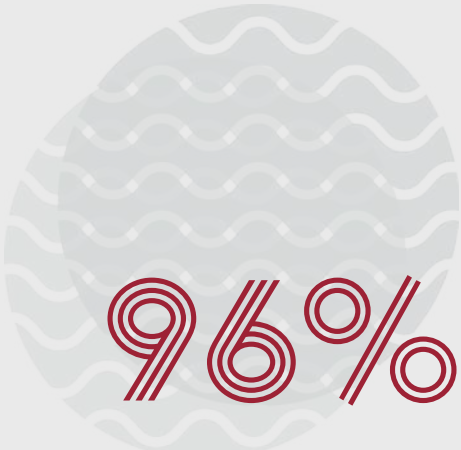
Communication: an Essential Career Skill



80%

of recruiters consider interpersonal skills more important than any other type of skill.

Source: Graduate Management Admission Council



96%

of people think the businesses they interact with could improve in terms of communication.

Source: Project.co



86%

of employees state that lack of communication is the main cause of workplace failures

Source: Fierce, Inc.

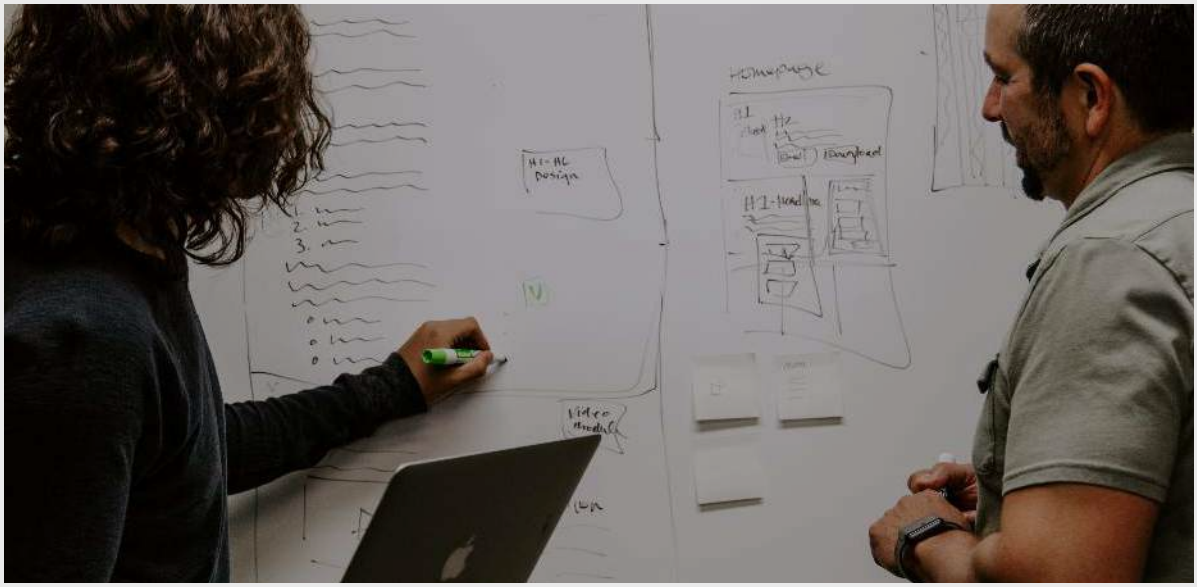
How to Capture and Maintain Audiences' Attention

Consequently, **expressing opinions in a persuasive and alluring manner is also an increasingly essential tool** for those looking to secure investments or advance in their organizations.

For engineers and other highly skilled professionals, this may present an even greater challenge.

These experts may be used to speaking or presenting data to peers who possess extensive knowledge of the same field, complicating their ability to convey the same ideas to people with less technical experience.

Only through effective communication will professionals be able to move their business and projects forward.



About this Course



Have you ever grown frustrated because you were trying to explain a technical issue to someone who didn't understand the **highly specialized terminology?**

Have you seen others' ideas become more successful because the people behind them were able to **express themselves more succinctly**? Enhancing your communication and persuasive skills can offer a significant **upgrade in both your personal and professional life,** while also bolstering your overall communication style.

MIT Professional Education's online course **Persuasive Communication: Critical Thinking to Enhance Your Message** aims to help participants hone their **interpersonal skills** in vital areas such as **public speaking, critical thinking, digital communication, visual persuasion, and audience adaptation both virtually and in person.**

This course is geared towards professionals who need to convey their ideas with precision, pitch projects, speak at events or presentations, or conduct interviews as an integral part of their career.

9 weeks | 8-10 hours a week | Online

Key Takeaways

This course is designed to **refine participants' communication and interpersonal skills,** allowing clear, precise information to be delivered in an effective and persuasive manner. It also aims to **guide highly skilled technical professionals to adapt their message to a non-technical audience.**

The skills and knowledge presented in this course can be applied across multiple industries, including engineering, tech, human resources, sales, sustainability, and entrepreneurship, among others.

Due to its extensive application and the increasing need for **universally effective communication**, the expertise on offer can also be of great value in participants' own personal lives.

Throughout this course you will:

01 Learn about **disparate communication styles** and how they influence attitudes and behaviors.

02 Discover the **psychology behind persuasion** and implement it in your own professional interactions.

03 Understand which characteristics **make a great public speaker** and learn to apply them to yourself.

04 Master how to **adapt your message to different audiences,** including those with differing levels of technical knowledge.

05 Explore the impact of **digitalization in communication** and learn to manage virtual communications in an effective, powerful manner.

06 Find out which processes are behind **critical thinking** and how to use them to upgrade your message.

07 Comprehend the importance of **data visualization** to clarify your data for any kind of audience.

08 Devise a **communication strategy** for your organization.



Participant Profile

This course offers a set of communicative tools that could benefit professionals at any level across a vast number of industries, including:

C-level executives wanting to improve both vertical and horizontal communication to ensure that objectives are aligned throughout their organization.

Engineers and other technical professionals who need to communicate with those from nontechnical backgrounds, as well as people without technical knowledge who need to communicate with engineers and other tech professionals.

Any professional looking to enhance their critical thinking by constructing and evaluating claims and arguments that can be confidently presented to persuade others within their organization and beyond it.

Business leaders who need to deliver data and information across a variety of media channels to diverse audiences.

Sustainability and climate change specialists looking to incorporate knowledge about portfolio management, programs, and projects.

Entrepreneurs and other dynamic professionals who rely on effective communication to turn their ideas into actionable plans for presentation.

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Instructor



Prof. Edward Schiappa

John E. Burchard, Professor of Humanities and Co-chair of the Gender Equity Committee of the School of Humanities, Arts, & Social Sciences, MIT

Edward Schiappa is an American scholar of communication and rhetoric and was recently appointed to co-chair of the Gender Equity Committee of the School of Humanities, Arts, & Social Sciences.
He is currently Professor of Comparative Media Studies/Writing at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology, where he holds the John E. Burchard Chair of Humanities; from 2013 to 2019, he also served as the program's Head. He is the author of eleven books and numerous articles that have appeared in classics, communication, English/Composition, philosophy, psychology, and law journals.
Schiappa has developed influential lines of research in three areas: classical rhetoric, contemporary rhetorical theory and argumentation, and popular culture.

His research has appeared in such journals as Philosophy & Rhetoric, Argumentation, Communication Monographs, and Communication Theory. He was named a National Communication Association Distinguished Scholar in 2009.

“There is no such thing as “just the facts”. All data has to be interpreted and there are lot of choices involved on how to present that data that makes it a persuasive and a rhetorical act.”

Author of ‘The Transgender Exigency: Defining Sex & Gender in the 21st Century’

Received ‘NCA's Douglas W. Ehninger Distinguished Rhetorical Scholar’ Award

Named a National Communication Association Distinguished Scholar

Course Outline

Module 1
Introduction

1. The Ubiquity of Persuasion
2. Communication Theories
3. Persuasion Theory 101
4. Communication Challenges in the Workplace

Module 2
The Public Speaker

1. A Model of Communication
2. Performing Persona
3. The Total Communicator
4. 12 Steps to Effective Public Speaking

Module 3
Storytelling

1. Humas, the storytelling animal
2. Storytelling 101
3. Tell your story

Module 4
Critical Thinking 101: Forms of Reasoning

1. Senses of Argument
2. Analyzing arguments
3. Forms of Reasoning Part I
4. Forms of Reasoning Part II
5. Arguing about values

Module 5
Introduction to Data Visualization

1. Introduction to Data Visualization
2. DataViz Is Big Business
3. DataViz Is Part Art, Part Science
4. Data Accuracy

Module 6
Adapting Messages and Media to Audiences

1. Adapting Persuasive Messages to Audiences
2. The Role of Culture in Communication across Cultures / Cultural Differences
3. Work with Your Audience, Don't Oppose Them. Persuading Hostile Audiences
4. Adapting Scientific & Technical Communication to Nonexpert Audiences

Module 7
Digital Persuasion

1. Just How Different Is Communication in the Digital Age?
2. Persuasion Theory in a Digital Age
3. Going Digital: Presentations in Digital Media
4. Storytelling with Digital Tools
5. Managing Your Social Media Persona
6. Best Practices in Emails

Module 8
Visual Persuasion

1. The Importance of Visual Persuasion
2. Mastering the Syntax and Semantics of Visual Language
3. How to Present Complicated Information Quickly

Module 9
Conclusion: Devising a Communication Strategy

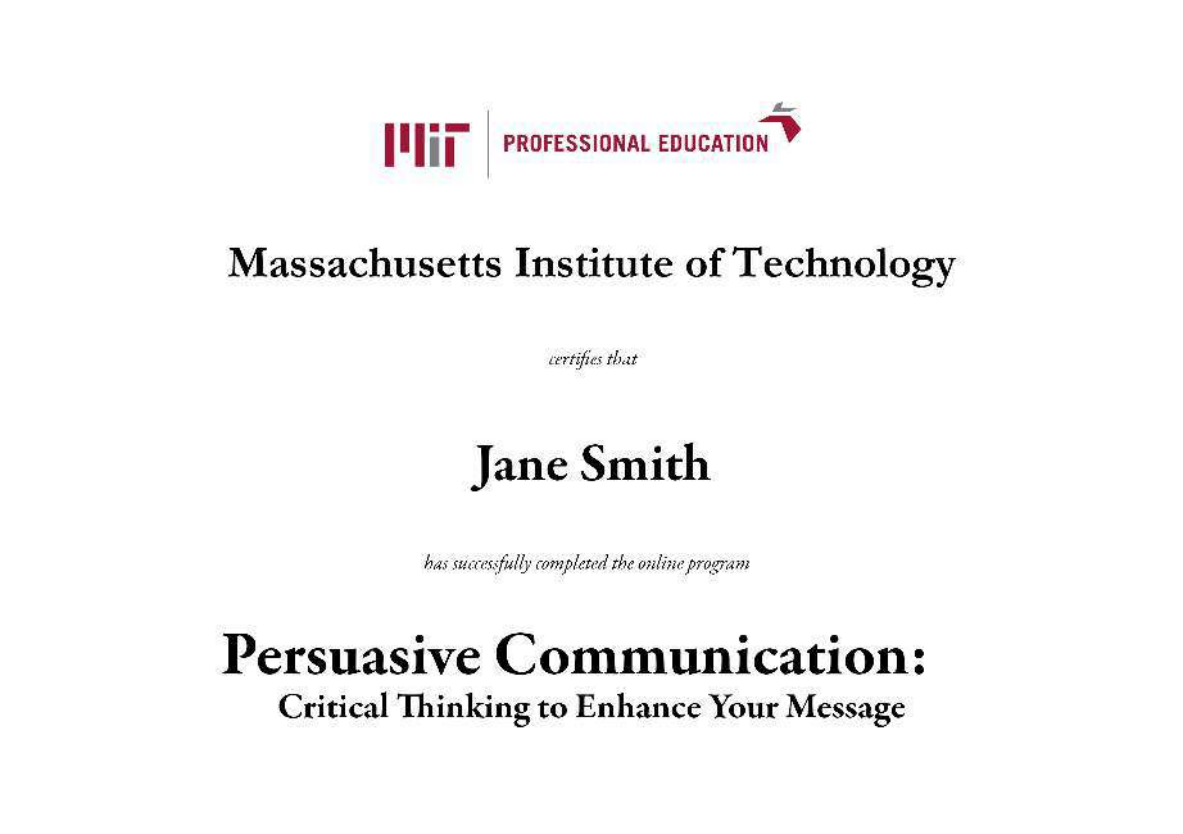
1. Your "You" Strategy
2. Identifying & Strategizing about Your Biggest Communication Challenges
3. A Checklist for Communication Competence in a Digital Age

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Certificate of Completion

All participants who successfully complete the course will receive an MIT Professional Education Certificate of Completion and 7.2 Continuing Education Units (CEUs*).

In order to obtain CEUs, participants must complete a required CEU accreditation form. CEUs are calculated based on the number of learning hours in each course.



The Continuing Education Unit (CEU) is defined as 10 contact hours of ongoing learning to indicate the amount of time they have devoted to a non-credit/non-degree professional development program. To understand whether or not these CEUs may be applied toward professional certification, licensing requirements, or other required training or continuing education hours, please consult your training department or licensing authority directly.



Welcome to the gateway

to MIT knowledge and expertise for professionals around the world.

155

Participants from 155 countries

+1600

More than 1,600 online activities

92%

92% of Professional Alumni rated their experience as outstanding

About MIT Professional Education

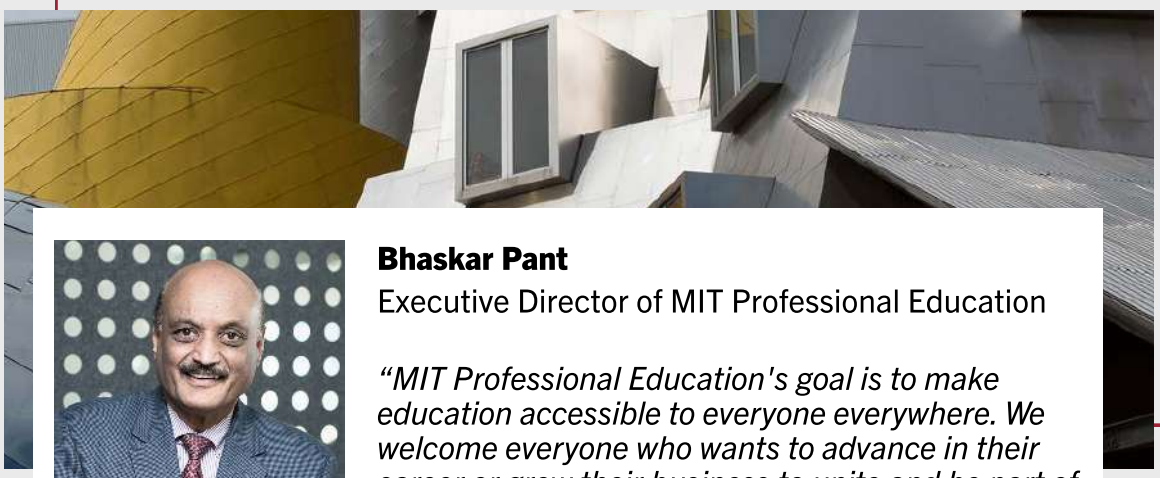
MIT Professional Education fosters the development of innovative leaders equipped to address complex problems globally

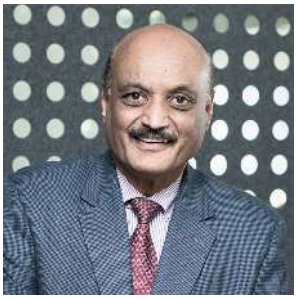
MIT Professional Education provides continuing education courses and lifelong learning opportunities for science, engineering, and technology professionals at all levels, from around the world. Worthy of note is that **MIT professors and lecturers lead and teach all MIT Professional Education offerings**. Some of our programs have a long history. Others are relatively new.

Our Digital Plus Programs go beyond online, blending innovative content delivered using the best of online technology and traditional classroom instruction in a flexible, collaborative learning environment.

MIT Professional Education is central to MIT's vision. It fulfills the mandate to connect practitioner-oriented education with industry and incorporate industry feedback and knowledge into MIT education and research.

The Institute is committed to generating, disseminating, and preserving knowledge while working with others to apply this **knowledge for the benefit of humankind.**





Bhaskar Pant
Executive Director of MIT Professional Education

"MIT Professional Education's goal is to make education accessible to everyone everywhere. We welcome everyone who wants to advance in their career or grow their business to unite and be part of the MIT Professional Education all-inclusive community."

Corporate Courses

At MIT Professional Education, we are committed to accompanying organizations as they aspire to provide their professionals with the ongoing education critical for **success in today's competitive environment**. That's why we offer plans for companies who wish to train their professionals with us.

Which program best suits your organization's needs?

1

Standard Program:
Teams or groups of at least 10 people will obtain special conditions in their registration for any of our programs.

2

Custom Programs:
Custom-made to meet the specific needs of each organization and its professionals.

3

Private Cohorts:
Available in Open Enrollment courses with a minimum of participants.

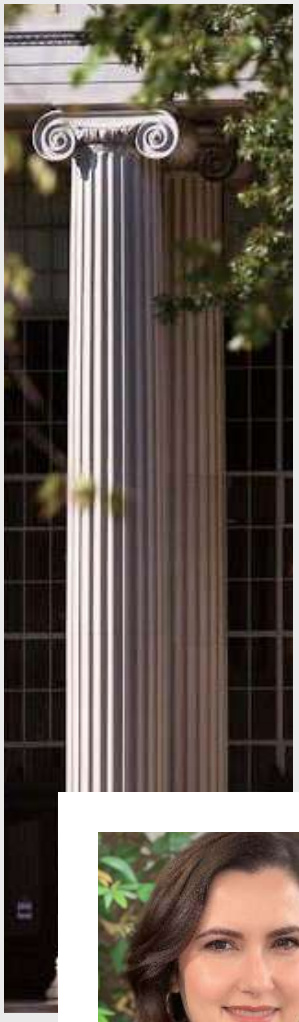


For more information on our Programs for Organizations, please contact us at: **professionalprograms@mit.edu**

The Beyond Online Methodology

MIT Professional Education is **revolutionizing the digital learning experience**. In fact, we are no longer talking about online-only, but rather an **interactive and collaborative learning experience** that's digitally powered: a **Beyond Online experience.**

You will have access to one of the most innovative e-learning platforms that utilizes the latest technology.You will also have an opportunity to meet and work with some of the world's leading subject matter experts in their respective fields.



With MIT Professional Education, you'll have an opportunity to:

- Attend select live webinars with MIT Instructors.
- Collaborate and engage with world-renowned MIT Instructors.
- Learn from expert learning facilitators, guest speakers, and subject matter experts from industries.
- Weekly live webinars from learning facilitators.
- Fulfill your reskilling and upskilling needs in this fast-changing environment.
- Master the technical and human skills necessary for effective leadership.
- Meet and network with other program participants from all around the world.



Clara Piloto
Director of Global Programs at MIT Professional Education

"Becoming confident in public speaking skills is one of the best things you can do to boost your career. Regardless of your profession, persuasive and assured speaking is how you convey great ideas to an audience or an individual. When you can convince and sell your vision, you can get things done correctly the first time."

Benefits of Joining the Alumni Community



MIT Professional Education offers **a number of benefits for participants** who successfully complete our courses:

1. **15% tuition reduction** for MIT Professional Education online courses and short-duration, in-person programs.
2. **Continued access to the virtual campus for six months after completion** of the course.
3. **Exclusive announcements** of new courses, programs, and events through our **virtual Alumni Campus: Professional Network.**
4. Invitation to the **MIT Professional Education Alumni LinkedIn group.**
5. **Networking opportunities** with other MIT Professional Education Alumni.

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PROFESSIONAL EDUCATION
Digital Plus+ Programs

Are you ready to become the communicator your career needs?

Frequently Asked Questions

For more information, please contact us:
+1 617 870 0270
Email: **professionalprograms@mit.edu**
Website: **https://professionalprograms.mit.edu**

global alumni
-excellence or nothing-